

Code of Business Conduct

Policy

This Code of Business Conduct and Ethics outlines the standards of behaviour expected from all employees, directors, and contractors. It applies to all operations across South Africa, the United Kingdom, the United States, Nigeria, Lesotho, Eswatini (Swaziland), and our Arab country markets. We deliver ad-hoc services, business consulting, and research services with integrity, objectivity, and professionalism.

Professional Integrity in Service Delivery

Our reputation rests on the quality and honesty of our outputs. We ensure that our advisory, research, and ad-hoc services meet rigorous professional standards.

- **Objective Research:** We gather and analyse data impartially. We never manipulate research outcomes to suit specific agendas.
- **Scope Clarity:** We define ad-hoc project scopes clearly. This prevents scope creep and ensures transparent billing.
- **Expert Competence:** We only accept consulting engagements we are qualified to deliver.
- **Fact-Based Advice:** Our consulting recommendations rely on verified data and realistic assessments.

Global Compliance and Legal Standards

We respect and adhere to the laws of every nation where we operate. Employees must navigate differing regulatory frameworks with diligence.

- **Anti-Corruption:** We strictly prohibit bribery and kickbacks. This aligns with the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA), the UK Bribery Act, and local anti-corruption laws in Nigeria and South Africa.
- **Sanctions and Trade:** We screen all clients in Arab countries and international markets against global sanctions lists.
- **Tax Compliance:** We accurately report revenues and pay required taxes in all operating jurisdictions.
- **Labour Laws:** We uphold fair labor practices, safe working conditions, and statutory minimum wages across all regions, including Lesotho and Eswatini.

Data Protection and Client Confidentiality

As a research and consulting firm, we handle sensitive proprietary data and personal information. Protecting this data is a core legal and ethical obligation.

- **Privacy Regulation:** We comply with the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA) in South Africa, the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) in the UK, and relevant state laws in the US.
- **Non-Disclosure:** We never disclose client information to third parties without explicit written consent.
- **Information Security:** We store all research data, client briefs, and consulting frameworks on secure, encrypted systems.
- **Data Minimisation:** We collect only the personal data necessary to complete the specific research or service requested.

Diversity, Inclusion, and Respect

Our multinational footprint requires deep respect for cultural differences and a commitment to equal opportunity.

- **Zero Tolerance:** We prohibit discrimination or harassment based on race, gender, religion, age, sexual orientation, or nationality.
- **Cultural Sensitivity:** We respect the local customs, religious traditions, and business etiquette of our stakeholders in Arab countries, African nations, and Western markets.
- **BEE Support:** We actively support Broad-Based Black Economic Empowerment (B-BBEE) principles within our South African operations.
- **Fair Workplace:** We base all hiring, promotions, and compensation strictly on merit, skills, and performance.

Conflicts of Interest

We avoid situations where personal interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with the interests of the company or our clients.

- **Disclosure:** Employees must immediately disclose any financial or personal interest in a client or competitor business.
- **Concurrent Employment:** Staff cannot perform ad-hoc or consulting services outside the company that compete with our offerings.

- **Gifts and Entertainment:** We prohibit accepting gifts that exceed nominal value or influence business decisions.
- **Research Independence:** Analysts must not hold financial stakes in industries or companies they are actively researching.

Implementation and Reporting

This policy is actively enforced through continuous oversight, clear reporting channels, and strict accountability.

- **Regular Training:** All global staff must complete annual training on this Code and local regulatory updates.
- **Whistleblowing Channels:** We provide secure, confidential channels for employees to report ethical breaches without fear of retaliation.
- **Investigation Process:** The company investigates every reported violation promptly, fairly, and thoroughly.
- **Disciplinary Action:** Breaches of this Code result in disciplinary measures, up to and including immediate termination of employment or contracts.